

# Lab 4: Executive Briefing Challenge

**Time:** 30 minutes

**What you need:** Claude.ai Pro or Team account

**Files provided:** Use files from Labs 2-3, plus `executive-briefing-inputs.txt`

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## The Challenge

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Your CEO just pinged you: "Board meeting moved to Wednesday. I need a 2-page briefing on our competitive position and Q4 performance. Include a recommendation on where to invest in Q1. On my desk by end of day."

You have everything you need from today's labs. Now put it all together.

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## Step 1: Set Up Your Project (5 min)

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1. Create a new Project: "**Board Briefing - Q1 2026**"
2. Add Custom Instructions:

Audience: CEO and Board of Directors

Tone: Executive – confident, concise, data-driven

Format: Professional briefing with headers, no fluff

Numbers: Always include specific figures, percentages, and comparison

Recommendations: Always support with data from the uploaded files

Length: Concise – executives skim, not read

1. Upload these files to the Project:

2. `q4-sales-data.csv` (from Lab 3)
  3. `competitor-intel.txt` (from Lab 3)
  4. `executive-briefing-inputs.txt` (new — strategic context)
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## Step 2: Build the Briefing (15 min)

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Work through these prompts in sequence. Each builds on the last.

### Prompt 1 — Extract key metrics:

"Review all uploaded files. Extract the 5 most important metrics a CEO would want to see for a board meeting. Include the actual numbers."

### Prompt 2 — Competitive position:

"Write a 'Competitive Landscape' section for the board briefing. Summarize our position vs. the 3 competitors. Highlight the biggest threat and our biggest advantage. Keep it to one paragraph."

### Prompt 3 — Build the full briefing:

"Create a 2-page Executive Briefing artifact for the CEO. Include:

1. Q4 Performance Snapshot (key metrics in a table)
2. Competitive Landscape (from our analysis)
3. Risk Factors (what could hurt us in Q1)
4. Q1 Investment Recommendation (where to spend, with justification)

Format it as a professional document — headers, tables where appropriate, clear section breaks. This goes to the board."

### Prompt 4 — Iterate:

"The CEO prefers bullet points over paragraphs in risk sections. Also add a one-line summary at the very top — a 'bottom line up front' the board can read in 10 seconds."

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## Step 3: Polish and Present (10 min)

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### Add a visual:

"Create a simple table or chart showing Q4 revenue by region with quota comparison. Include it in the briefing."

### Quality check:

"Review this briefing as if you were the CEO's chief of staff. Flag anything that's vague, unsupported by data, or missing. Then fix it."

### Final version:

"Give me the final version as a clean artifact I can copy into a Word document."

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## Share with the Class

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If time permits, your instructor will ask: 1. What's your "bottom line up front"? 2. What's your Q1 investment recommendation? 3. What surprised you about the data?

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## Reflection: What You Did Today

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| Time           | Without Claude   | With Claude    |
|----------------|------------------|----------------|
| Q4 Analysis    | 2-3 hours        | 10 minutes     |
| Battle Card    | 1-2 hours        | 10 minutes     |
| Board Briefing | Half a day       | 30 minutes     |
| <b>Total</b>   | <b>4-7 hours</b> | <b>~1 hour</b> |

This isn't about replacing your judgment. You still decided what matters, what to recommend, and what to cut. Claude handled the heavy lifting so you could focus on the thinking.

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## What You're Taking Home

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From today's 4 labs, you built: 1. ☐ Prompting skills you'll use every day (Lab 1) 2. ☐ A personalized AI workspace — settings, preferences, Project (Lab 2) 3. ☐ Data analysis and competitive intelligence workflow (Lab 3) 4. ☐ A board-ready executive briefing (Lab 4) 5. ☐ Reusable prompts and Project templates

**Monday morning:** Open Claude, open your Project, start working.

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"The goal isn't to use AI. The goal is to get better work done faster. AI is how."